

Joston Gary

<https://liu.se/en/employee/lirui88>
<https://www.ua.pt/en/p/80660201>
ORCID: 0009-0002-1874-2056

+351 937 919 346
lirui@ua.pt
li.rui@liu.se

EDUCATION

University of Aveiro, Portugal

Ph.D. in Marketing and Strategy, *expected* Dec 2027.

European Doctorate Label

University of Minho, Portugal

Ph.D. in Marketing and Strategy, *expected* Dec 2027.

European Joint Doctorate Degree.

Linköping University, Sweden

Ph.D. in Business Administration (Marketing Track), Sep 2025 to Aug 2027.

European Doctorate Track (Visting Ph.D. Student).

City University of Macau, Macau S.A.R.

M.Phil. in Business Administration, Sep. 2021 to July 2023.

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, United States of America.

M.S. in Management, Sep 2026 to Sep 2028.

Thomas Edison State University, United States of America

B.S. in Business Administration (Marketing Track), Jan 2026 to Dec 2026.

University of the People, United States of America

B.S. in Computer Science, Jan. 2025 to June 2026.

Chongqing Institute of Engineering, China

B.Eng. in Civil Engineering, Sep. 2017 to June 2021.

JSS Academy of Higher Education and Research, India

B.S. in Psychology, Sep. 2023 to Oct 2026.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Machine Learning, Marketing Model, Consumer Behavior, Digital Marketing, Tourism Marketing

WORKING PAPERS

“Information push strategies in e-commerce: Emotional and cognitive mechanisms shaping purchase decisions: Multi-method approaches” March 2025.

This study investigates the impact of Information Push Notifications (IPNs) on consumer sentiment, cognitive

appraisals, and behavioral outcomes in the Chinese e-commerce market using the Affect-as-Information Theory (AIT).

APA 7th: Gary, J. (2025). Information push strategies in e-commerce: Emotional and cognitive mechanisms shaping purchase decisions: Multi-method approaches. Journal of Marketing Analytics. (Scopus Q1; ESCI; ABS 1; CiteScore 6.1)

“The subtle power of nudging: consumer choice in ethical and sustainable retailing” August 2025.

This study investigates how nudging mechanisms in brand cues and social interactions influence ethical and sustainable consumer behavior in religious markets.

APA 7th: Gary, J., Lu, J., Feng, Y., Yang, G., Chuah, S.-C., & Moreira, A. C. The subtle power of nudging: consumer choice in ethical and sustainable retailing. Journal of Marketing Analytics. (Scopus Q1; ESCI; ABS 1; CiteScore 6.1)

“Development of the Modern Logistics Industry and Its Role in Promoting Regional Economic Growth in China's Underdeveloped Northwest Driven by the Digital Economy” Aug 2025.

The digital economy is a key driver of industrial upgrading and regional growth. Focusing on Gansu Province—an under-represented, less-developed region in northwest China—this study constructs a multidimensional digital economy index (DEI) for 2009–2023 under a unified normalisation and weighting scheme.

APA 7th: Jiang, L., Soo-Cheng, C., Dong-mei, X., Gary, J. The Development of the Modern Logistics Industry and Its Role in Promoting Regional Economic Growth in China's Underdeveloped Northwest, Driven by the Digital Economy. Economies. 2025; 13(9):261. (Scopus Q1; ESCI; ABS 1; CiteScore 4.7)

“Examining the Determinants of User Stickiness in a Mobile Video Application: A Flow Theory Perspective” January 2025.

This study investigates the determinants of user stickiness in short video applications through the lens of Flow Theory.

APA 7th: Gary, J. (2025). Examining the determinants of user stickiness in a mobile video application: A flow theory perspective. International Journal of Electronic Commerce Studies, 15(4). (Scopus Q3; CiteScore 1.7)

“Examining the interplay of information, emotions, and behavior: PLS-ANN analysis” September 2024.

This study investigates the interplay between platform information push, consumer emotions, and purchase behavior in Macau's cross-border e-commerce context using PLS-ANN analysis and piecewise linear regression.

APA 7th: Gary, J. (2024). Examining the interplay of information, emotions, and behavior: PLS-ANN analysis. Frontiers in Communication. 9:1411870. (Scopus Q1; ESCI; CiteScore 3.0)

“Dual-Credit Policy of New Energy Automobiles in China: Corporate Innovation Capability” December 2024.

This study investigates the impact of China's Dual-Credit Policy on innovation capability in the new energy vehicle (NEV) industry using a difference-in-differences approach with dynamic panel data from 2013 to 2022.

APA 7th: Gary, J., Zhao, P., & Bao, Z. (2024). Dual-Credit Policy of New Energy Automobiles in China: Corporate Innovation Capability. Sustainability, 16(17), 7504. (Scopus Q1; SSCI; CiteScore 7.7)

“Analysis on The Current Situation of Social Governance of Smart Cities in The Greater Bay Area” June 2022. *Conference Paper*.

The intelligent transformation of cities is an important way to promote the sustainable development of cities. In this context, we must form a scientific and effective social governance system with the help of new models, new methods and new concepts.

APA 7th: Li, Qiong & Joston, Gary (Li Rui) & He, Shike. (2022). Analysis on The Current Situation of Social Governance of Smart Cities in The Greater Bay Area. 10.26914/c.cnkihy.2022.031361.

“Augmented Reality in Retail Technical and Emotional Factors After Experience: E-Commerce Consumption Decision” November 2025.

This study examines how technical features and emotional responses in augmented reality retail experiences shape consumers’ post-experience evaluations and e-commerce purchase decisions.

APA 7th: Gary, J., Xixing, Z., Tang, Y. M., Yang, G., & Moreira, A. C. (2025). *Augmented Reality in Retail: Technical and Emotional Factors After Experience - E-Commerce Consumption Decision*. *Journal of Global Information Management (JGIM)*, 33(1), 1-60. (Scopus Q1; SSCI; ABS 2; ABDC A; CiteScore 8.0)

“How music video metaphors build destination brand resonance: Dyadic affect, meaning access, and cultural cues” November 2025.

This study explains how short-form destination videos use music–image metaphors to build destination brand resonance through dyadic affect, meaning access, and culturally framed cues.

APA 7th: Gary, J., Gu, Y., Wang, H., Zhou, X., Yan, F. & Moreira, A. C. (2026). *How music–video metaphors build destination brand resonance: Dyadic affect, meaning access, and cultural cues*. *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*. 89 (Part B). (Scopus Q1; SSCI; ABS 2; ABDC A; CiteScore 22.7)

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

“Efficiency Assessment and Cross-Country Differences in China-ASEAN Agricultural Trade Supply Chains: A Data Envelopment Analysis Based on a Multidimensional Input Perspective”, Under review by Cogent Economics & Finance, Jan 2026.

Received funding from Linköping University - Library, Sweden.

PROFESSIONAL AND UNIVERSITY SERVICES

Referee for: *Acta Psychologica*, *Journal of Marketing Analytics*, *Tourism & Management Studies*, *Asia Pacific Journal of Marketing and Logistics*, *International Journal of Electronic Commerce Studies*, *International Journal of Human–Computer Interaction*, *Scientific Report*, *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (Nature)*

National Scholarship (Undergraduate Students), 2018 to 2019

Director Assistant, Chongqing Institute of Engineering, 2017 to 2021

Social Worker, Chongqing Huiling Social Worker Association, 2019 to 2021

Psychology Association President, Chongqing Institute of Engineering, 2018 to 2020

Member, AMA - American Marketing Association, 2024 – Present

Member, ECIU - European Consortium of Innovative Universities, 2024 – Present

Research Grant from Chongqing Municipal Education Research Experimental Base, 2023 to 2025

Undergraduate Scholarship, Chongqing Institute of Engineering, 2018 to 2020

Doctoral Scholarship, Foundation for Science and Technology, Portugal, 2024 – Present

TEACHING ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate: Graduation Project (Thesis)

MBA: Quantitative Methods, Graduation Project (Thesis)

RESEARCH ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant for Professors: António Carrizo Moreira (The University of Manchester), Lars Witell (Linköping University), Rui Patrício (University of Aveiro).

Host Institution: GOVCOPP at University of Aveiro and FEK at Linköping University. Present. Projects on statistical modeling, sustainability consumption, tourism luxury.

Computer skills: Extensive programming experience including Python, SPSS, Smart PLS, AMOS, Stata, R, Excel, Mplus, and Visual Advance.

Research Assistant for Professors: Yuk Ming Tang, The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Host Institution: Hong Kong Polytechnic University, 2022 to 2023

Projects on Dynamic Pricing Strategies Using Machine Learning; Psychological Drivers of Brand Loyalty in Digital Contexts.

Computer skills: Extensive programming experience including Python, SPSS, Visual Advance.

Research Assistant for Professors: Haoyu Liu, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Host Institution: City University of Macau. 2022.

Projects on Consumer Behavior Modeling Using Multivariate Techniques.

Computer skills: Extensive programming experience including SPSS, Smart PLS, AMOS, Excel, and Visual Based.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

China Overseas Property Co., Ltd. (Zhuhai), Zhuhai, Guangdong, China., 2022

Business Analysis, Department of Marketing and Analysis

Analyze historical financial data and compare the financial performance of internal companies with industry competitors. Use Stata software to clean data through automated filtering of system data. Analyze the budget for administrative and manufacturing expenses and apply budget adjustments. Management accounting techniques. Prepare research reports on expected profits in online business districts and consumer behavior analysis.

Chongqing Foreign Construction (Group) Co., Ltd., Chungking, China, 2020 to 2021

Assistant Civil Engineer, Division of Engineering

Project supervision: Served as construction supervisor in 5 large-scale construction projects, ensuring that the projects were completed 10% ahead of schedule and the construction period was shortened to 8 months. Quality control: Responsible for the quality inspection of 15,000 tons of concrete and more than 20,000 square meters of steel structure materials, ensuring zero quality accidents in the project. Drawing optimization: Reviewed and optimized 35 sets of design drawings, helping to reduce 20% of material waste and improve construction efficiency. Budget management: Participated in the 200 million CNY project budget, successfully saved 10% of costs, and optimized resource allocation. Safety management: Implemented 50 safety inspections, discovered and eliminated 12 major safety hazards, and achieved zero accident records.

iQIYI, Peking, China., 2019

Data Analyst, Big Data Center

Use Stata to filter consumption data from the internal app and obtain 16,475 user profiles to build a comprehensive profile system. Clean and filter the extracted data using Python, selecting complex monitoring data to meet marketing plan requirements. Process non-standard tags and extract over 58,000 pieces of sensitive information to create a marketing research report. Prepare the "Q3 2019 Mobile Live Streaming Marketing Research Report".

REFERENCES AND DISSERTATION COMMITTEE

Rui Patrício

Assistant Professor of Marketing

Division of Management

Department of Economics, Management, Industrial Engineering and Tourism, University of Aveiro

3810-193 Aveiro, Portugal

Email: rui.patricio@ua.pt

António Carrizo Moreira

Full Professor of Management

Department Chair, Department of Social Sciences and Management

Universidade Aberta

R. da Escola Politécnica n.º 147, 1269-001 Lisboa, Portugal

Email: antonio.moreira@uab.pt

Lars Witell

Full Professor of Business Management

Unit of Chair, Division of Business Administration, Department of Management and Engineering

Linköping University, 581 83, Linköping, Sweden

Email: lars.witell@liu.se

Phone: +4613282526